had promised when he first became prime minister.

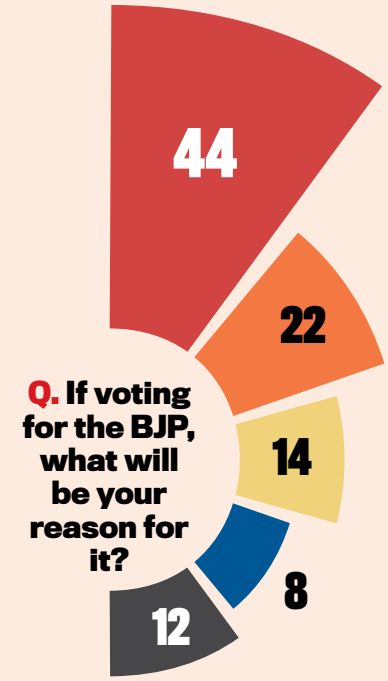
The sense of pessimism persists in MOTN respondents' view of the near term, with almost a third (33.8 per cent) saying the Indian economy will deteriorate further in the next half of the year. A majority of them (69 per cent) also do not foresee any improvement in their household income or salaries in the next six months; more than 60 per cent say their current expenses have become difficult to manage. A majority (55.5 per cent) deems the unemployment scenario to be very serious and only 30 per cent believe that Modi has done much proactively to generate employment. In another damning perception, 55.4 per cent believe that the NDA government's economic policies have benefited big business the most to the detriment of the small-scale sector, the salaried class, farmers and daily wagers, who are seen to have been neglected. This sentiment has been consistent across the past four MOTNs. What doesn't help the government's case is the finding that a majority (47 per cent) agrees with Rahul Gandhi's allegation that the BJP favours the Adani Group and other big business houses.

On several key social and political issues too, the Modi government has drawn flak. On the ethnic crisis engulfing Manipur, 30 per cent lay the blame on the doorstep of the central government while 25 per cent believe the state government to be at fault. A majority of the respondents (43.8 per cent) favour sacking Chief Minister Biren Singh and imposing President's rule, besides fast-tracking negotiations and judicial probes.

There are other issues on which the government's handling has come in for criticism. On the question of restoring statehood to J&K, a majority (55.8 per cent) is in favour and, interestingly, 31.2 per cent want Article 370 reinstated with it. The government's handling of the protests by women wrestlers alleging sexual harassment and molestation at the hands of the president of the wrestling federation, a BJP MP, has also shown it in a poor light. Some 45.2 per cent also think the BJP government has misused agencies such as the Enforcement Directorate, the Central Bureau of Investigation and the income-tax department more than the previous governments. And that governors in non-BJP-ruled states have been partisan. As many as 49.8 per cent believe democracy to be in danger in India. And while 41.4 per cent believe communal harmony has improved under the NDA government, a high 34.1 per cent believe otherwise. An overwhelming majority of the Muslim and Christian respondents, in particular, believe that the communal situation has worsened under Modi's rule.

However, despite these negative perceptions, MOTN 2023 suggests

**Q. If voting for the BJP, what will be your reason for it?**



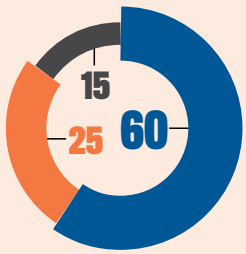

Prime Minister Narendra Modi
Development
Hindutva
Welfare schemes
All of the above

**Almost half the respondents will vote for the BJP because of Modi**

**68%**

**SAVARNA HINDUS, THE HIGHEST AMONG ALL CASTE GROUPS, ARE SATISFIED WITH THE NDA GOVT'S PERFORMANCE**

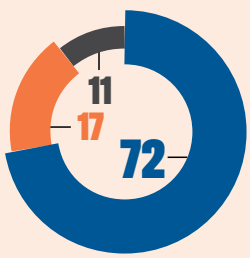
**Q. Do you think the BJP will gain from the split in Opposition parties in Maharashtra?**




Yes No DK/CS

**Most feel the vertical split in the NCP and Shiv Sena will benefit the BJP**

**Q. Will implementing the Uniform Civil Code (UCC) help the BJP electorally?**




Yes No DK/CS

**A majority thinks implementing the UCC will help the BJP in elections**

All figures in % and rounded off; DK/CS: don't know/can't say